

MODERN INDIAN HISTORY



MODULE - 19

POLICE AND ARMY REFORMS

Three pillars on which the British administration of India was based are

**CIVIL
SERVICES**



POLICE



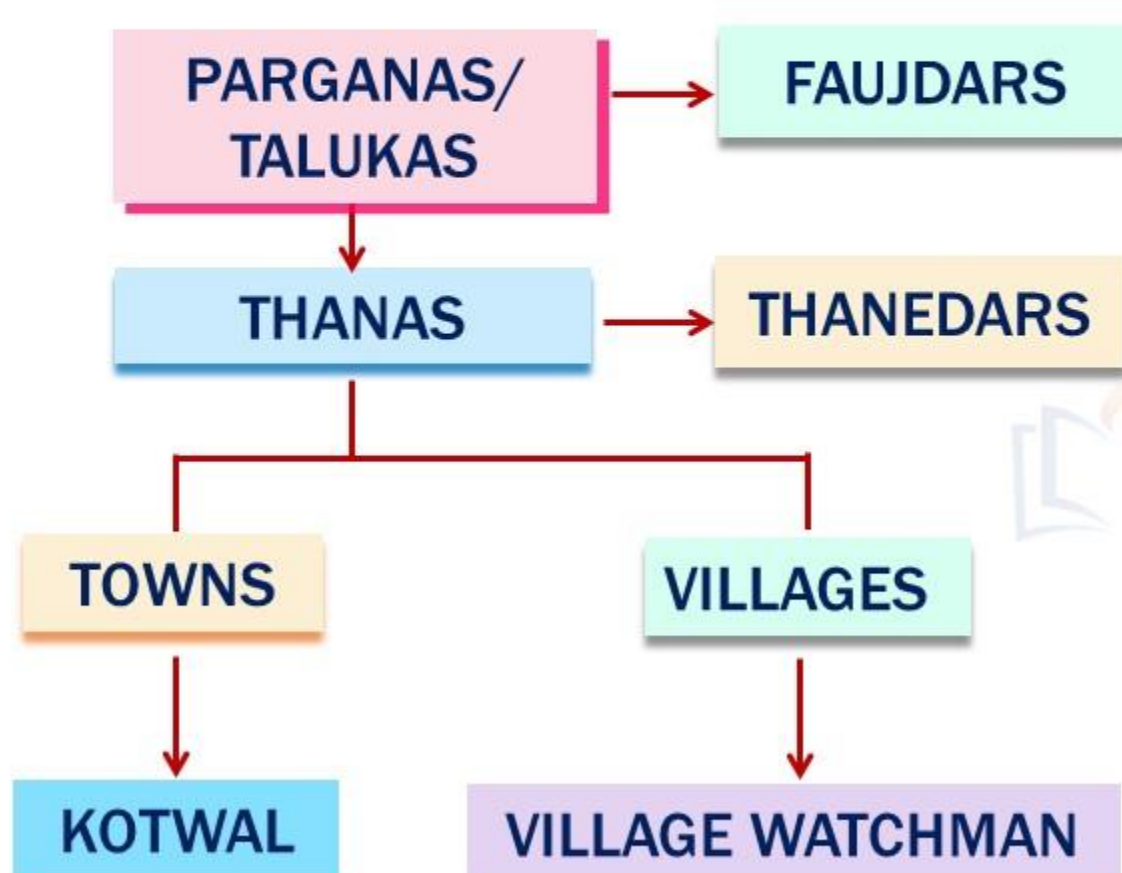
ARMY



EVOLUTION OF POLICE SYSTEM

PRE-COLONIAL POLICING

DURING MUGHAL RULERS



ZAMINDARS were responsible for maintaining law and order, ensuring peace and dealing with crimes and criminals.

Flaws in the system - very often, Zamindars neglected their duties. They colluded with dacoits and shared their loot.

EVOLUTION OF POLICE SYSTEM

COLONIAL POLICING SYSTEM

DURING CORNWALLIS, 1791



Cornwallis organized a regular police force and modernizing the old Indian system of *Thanas* (circles).

He relieved the zamindars of their police duties.

Flaws in the system

- The new system proved to be inadequate in bringing down the crime rate.
- *Zamindars* abused the system by taking advantage of its weaknesses.

EVOLUTION OF POLICE SYSTEM

COLONIAL POLICING SYSTEM

DURING LORD MINTO I, 1808



One layer was added and divided districts into various divisions.

He appointed an SP for each division **helped by a number of spies** (goyendas).

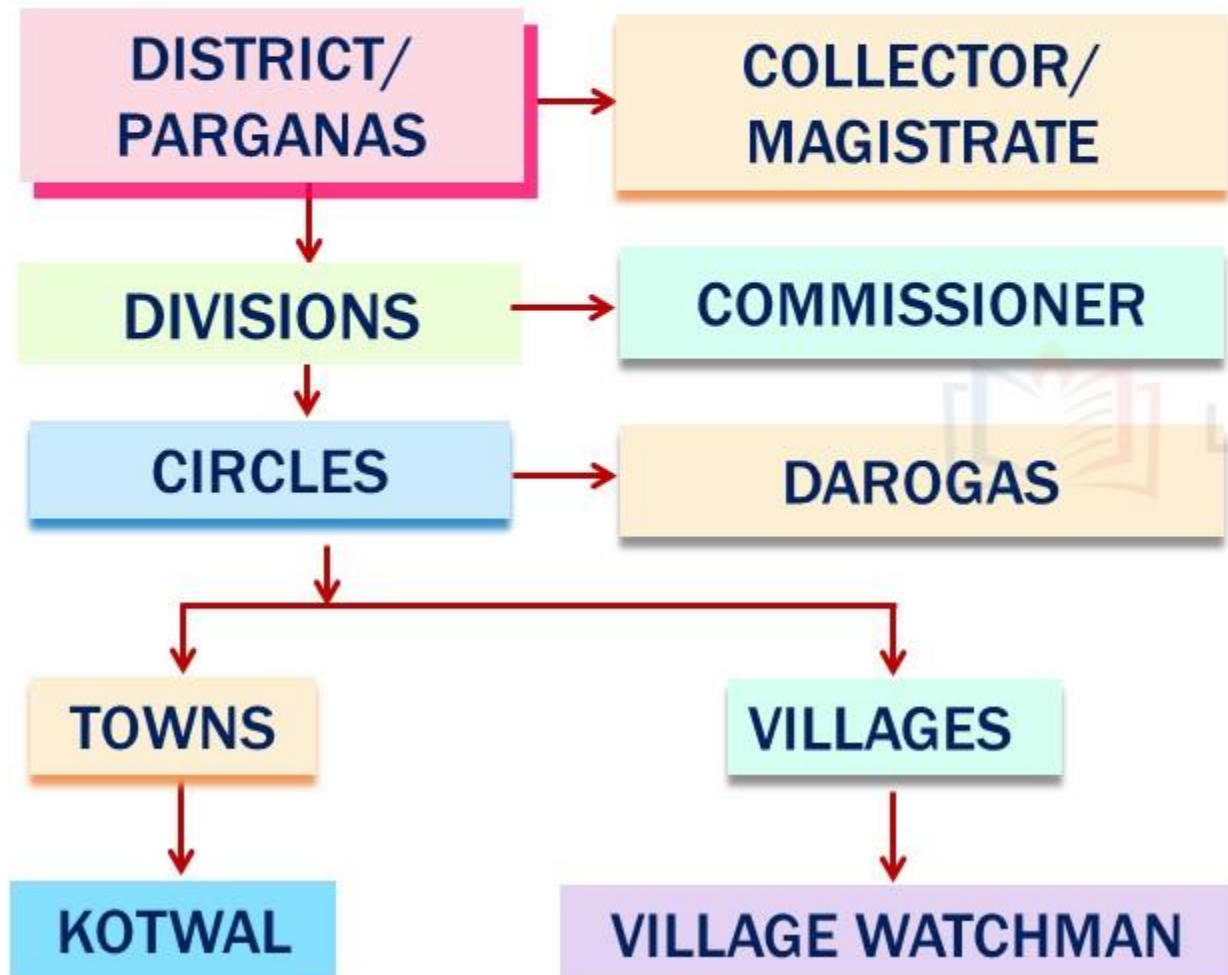
Flaws in the system-

- These spies committed depredations (plundering) on local people.

EVOLUTION OF POLICE SYSTEM

COLONIAL POLICING SYSTEM

DURING WILLIAM BENTINCK, 1828-1835



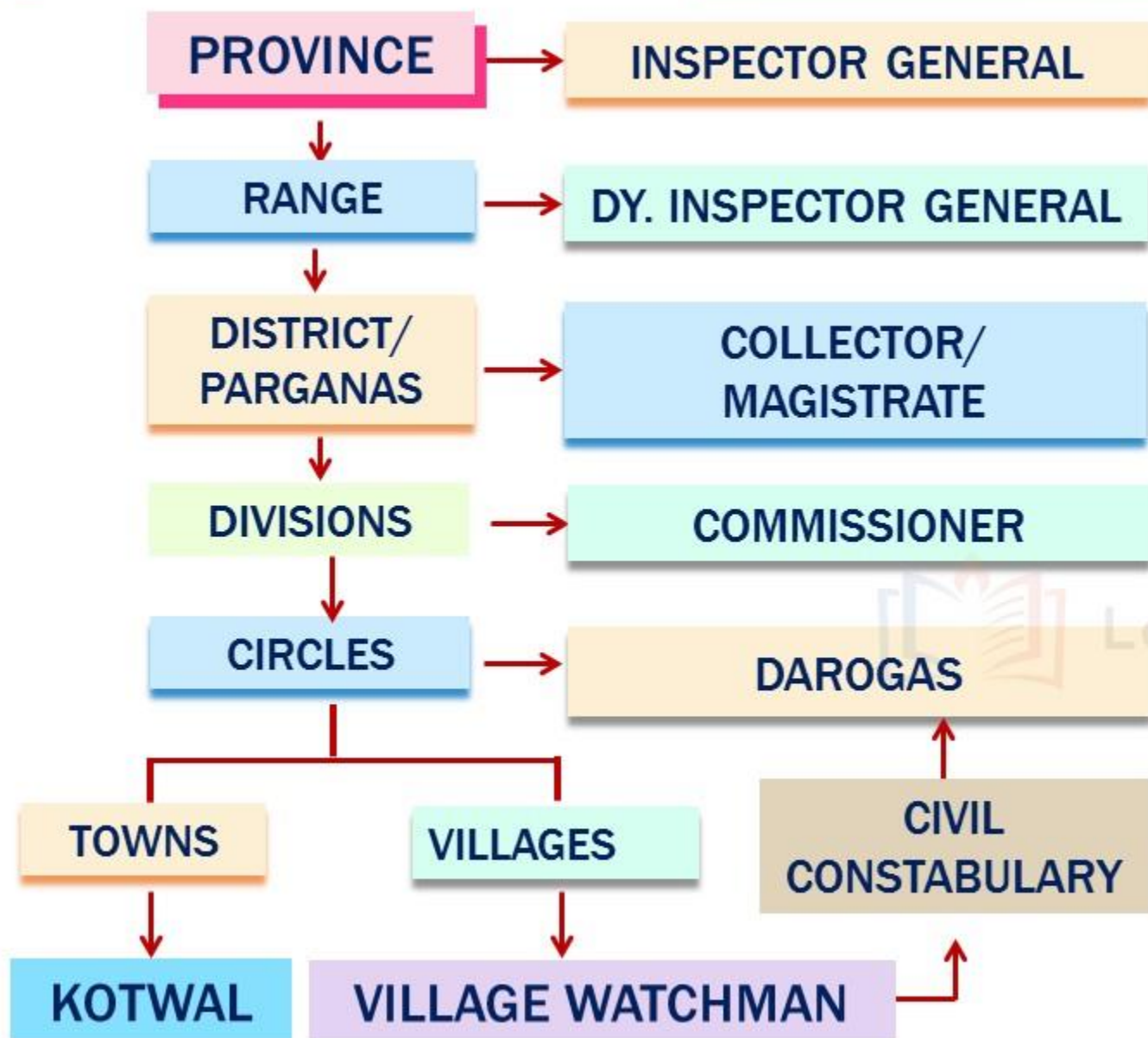
He **abolished** the office of the SP.

The collector/magistrate was now to head the police force in his jurisdiction and the commissioner in each division was to act as the SP.

Flaws in the system

This arrangement resulted in unbalanced division of power which ultimately leads to chaos, confusion and ambiguity in functions.

POLICE COMMISSION, 1860



Recommendations of the Police Commission (1860) led to the **Indian Police Act, 1861**

A **system of civil constabulary** which was in direct contact with Village watchman.

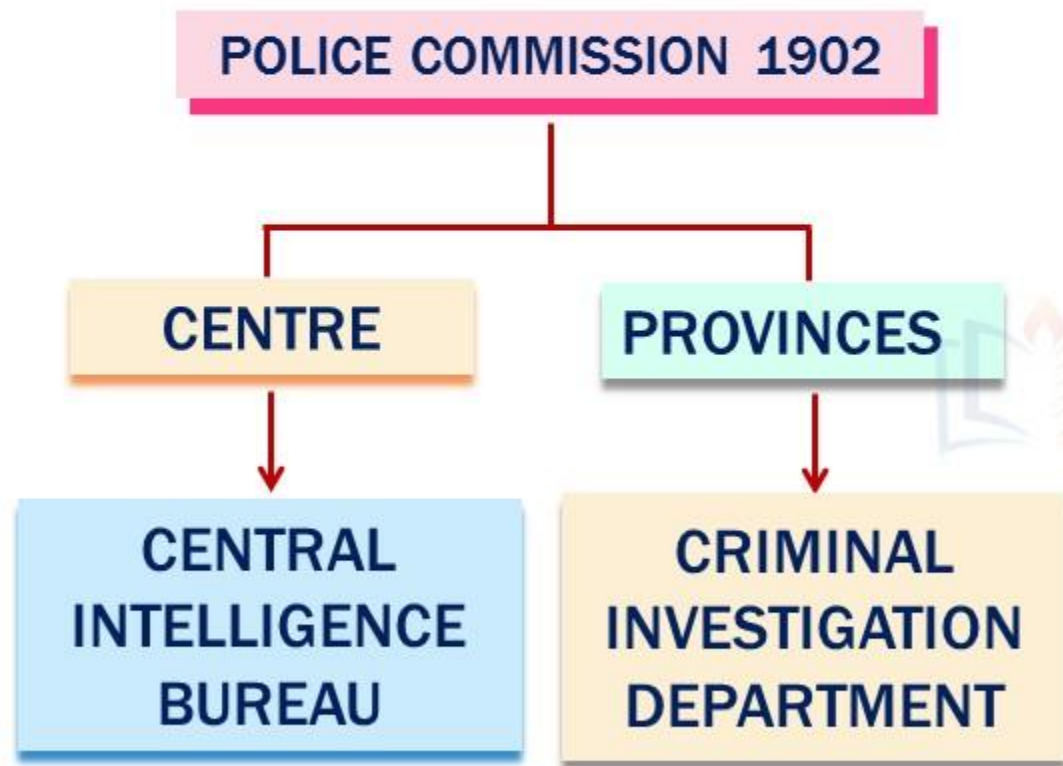
Evaluation of the system-

- **Police succeeded in curbing criminal acts**, such as dacoity, *thuggee*, etc.
- But, **while dealing with public, the attitude of police was unsympathetic.**
- Police was also used to suppress national movement.
- British **did not create an All-India Police.**

EVOLUTION OF POLICE SYSTEM

COLONIAL POLICING SYSTEM

POLICE COMMISSION, 1902



Police Commission was established for the Police reforms **under Sir Andrew Frazer**

It recommended the establishment of

- CID (Criminal Investigation Department) in the provinces and
- CIB (Central Intelligence Bureau) at the Centre.

Three pillars on which the British administration of India was based are

**CIVIL
SERVICES**



POLICE



ARMY



MILITARY UNDER BRITISH RULE

The military was the backbone of the Company's rule in India.

UNDER COMPANY RULE

REVOLT OF 1857

UNDER CROWN RULE

There were two separate sets of Military forces

CROWN'S ARMY

These were the
serving British
troops on duty in
India

COMPANY TROOPS

Mixture of European
regiments and Native
regiments recruited
locally from India

Systematic organization of the Army

EUROPEAN BRANCH

Army of occupation

Once expansion is
done in order to
have hold over the
region this branch
was used.

INDIAN BRANCH

Army of expansion

- Used to defend the Indian territory of the empire from other imperialist powers
- Used for expansion in Asia and Africa

MILITARY UNDER BRITISH RULE

DOMINATION OF EUROPEAN BRANCH OVER INDIAN BRANCH

TO UPHOLD THE DOMINATION, ARMY COMMISSION OF 1859 AND 1879 SUGGESTED SOME MEASURES

PROPORTION OF ARMY PERSONNEL

- Principle of a **one-third white army** (as against 14% before 1857).
- Proportion of Europeans was fixed at **one to two in Bengal Army** and **two to five in the Madras and Bombay Armies**.

MONOPOLY AT STRATEGIC AREAS

Strict European monopoly over **key geographical locations** and departments, such as **artillery, tanks and armed corps**, was maintained

USE OF SOPHISTICATED WEAPONS

Rifles given to Indians were of an inferior quality

APPOINTMENT AND PROMOTION

No Indians were allowed in the **officer rank**, and the highest rank an Indian could reach till 1914 was that of a subedar

MILITARY UNDER BRITISH RULE

REORGANISATION OF INDIAN BRANCH OF ARMY

Conscious efforts were taken to **check growth of nationalist feelings**, **prevent unity among soldiers** and **isolate them from rest of population** to avoid another revolt as of 1857 revolt.

British adopted **policy of balance and counterpoise** or **divide and rule**

Communal, caste, tribal and regional consciousness was **encouraged** to check growth of Nationalist feeling.

Ideology of 'martial races' and 'non-martial races' was **emphasized**. For example- after 1857 revolt more sikh soldiers were recruited in comparison to Awadh soldiers as they have helped British in 1857 revolt. So to justify their discrimination they argued that Sikh belongs to Martial race and more competent.

Caste and communal companies were introduced in all the regiments and **Indian regiments were made a mixture of various socio-ethnic groups** to check unity among soldiers.

Preventing newspapers, journals and nationalist publications from reaching them to prevent sensitivity towards suffering of the people.

MILITARY UNDER BRITISH RULE

INDIAN SANDHURST COMMITTEE

DEMANDS OF INDIAN

Demand
accept

BRITISH GOVERNMENT

To establish a military college in India along the lines of Sandhurst to Indianize the officer corps.

constituted the Indian Sandhurst Committee

Indian members of the committee included Jinnah and Motilal Nehru

- Proposed a large-scale increase in Indianization,
- Setting up of an Indian academy by 1933



ROYAL MILITARY ACADEMY SANDHURST

The Royal Indian Military Academy was opened in Dehradun in October 1932

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